



PaintTakeoff — Quick Guide

Measure your painting plans right on screen. No training needed.

First time opening the app

Double-click **PaintTakeoff-0.1.0-portable.exe**. Windows may show a blue "Windows protected your PC" message — that's normal for a new app. Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. Nothing is installed; the file is the whole program.

1 Open a plan

Click the big **Open a Plan (PDF)** button and pick the PDF your architect or GC sent you — or just drag the file anywhere onto the window.

Use the ◀ ▶ buttons (or your arrow keys) to move between pages. Most painting work is on the **floor plans** (the A-series sheets).

2 Set the scale

The app needs one real-world length before it can measure. Do this **once per page**:

- Click **Set Scale**.
- Click the **two ends of anything whose length you know** — a wall with its dimension written on it is perfect. Longer lines give better accuracy.
- Type the real length into the **Feet** and **Inches** boxes (fractions like 6½ are fine) and hit **Set Scale**.

If the plan already prints its scale, you can skip the clicking: pick it from the **Common scales...** dropdown instead (most house plans are ¼ inch = 1 foot).

The app then offers a quick **double-check**: measure one more known length, ideally pointing the other direction. It takes 10 seconds and catches stretched or mislabeled plans. Skip it if you're in a hurry.

Watch the badge at the top of the screen:

Scale is set ✓

good to go ·

⚠ Scale not confirmed

works, but double-check when you can

Remembered for you: the scale is saved per page, per file. Close the app and reopen the same plan tomorrow — your scale is still there.

3 Measure

Click **Measure**, then **click to start a line and keep clicking to add segments** — wall to wall, around obstacles. The running total follows your cursor. **Double-click or Enter to finish**. In a hurry, click-drag still works for a quick single line.

Finished measurements **stay on the page** — flip to another page and come back, they're still there (even after closing the app). Click one to select it; **Delete** removes it, and **Ctrl + Z** undoes your last one. New lines **snap** onto the ends of lines you've already drawn, so walls connect without gaps.

The toolbar also picks **what** you're measuring: **Wall** (default), **Trim** (baseboards & casing, priced per foot), or **Ceiling** (click the room's corners, double-click to close — you get square feet).

Open **Measurements** in the toolbar for the list of everything on the page. Every wall row has its own **ceiling height box** (change it for bulkheads and dropped ceilings) and shows its **wall square footage** — length × height. The bottom of the panel keeps the running **total wall area**, the number you quote from.

Openings — doors & windows

Click **Openings**, then click each door and window on the plan. Pick Door / Window / Slider and the app subtracts the standard size (21 / 15 / 40 sq ft — all adjustable) from your wall area. The panel shows **Gross – Openings = Net wall area**; net is the number you price. Leave the deduct checkbox off if you don't deduct openings.

Turn it into a quote

Once your rooms are measured, click **Quote**. The app applies Ontario painting rates — production speed, coverage, paint prices, labour — and gives you **gallons to buy, labour hours, and a quote price**, with sanity checks that warn you if a number looks off (usually a scale or ceiling-height slip).

Every rate lives in the **Price Book** (\$ button) — change anything to match how your shop prices, and it's remembered. **Export quote** downloads an Excel file with all measurements and the full quote breakdown.

Quick Area — rough room sizes in one click

Once the scale is set, click **Quick Area** and then **click inside a room**. The app fills the room and gives you a rough floor area and perimeter. Type the **ceiling height** and it shows the **rough wall square footage** — the number you actually price off.

- Every number on the card is editable — tweak anything that looks off.
- **Cut out an obstacle** subtracts things like cabinet blocks or islands.
- **Keep this room** saves it into your Measurements list.

It's "rough" on purpose: rooms with wide-open doorways can leak into the next room, and dashed-line rooms may fill in pieces. If a fill looks wrong, cancel and chain-measure the walls with the Measure tool instead.

Moving around the page

Zoom — Ctrl + mouse wheel, or the **-** / **+** buttons

Pan — drag with the mouse in *Move Around* mode, or hold **Space** and drag

Fit the page — Fit ▾ menu in the zoom cluster

Pages — arrow keys, or type a page number

Cancel / undo — **Esc** cancels · **Ctrl** + **Z** undoes

Modes — **V** move · **C** set scale · **M** measure

Good habits

- **Every page has its own scale.** A set can mix 1/4", 1/8", and metric sheets — check the badge each time you flip pages.
- **Calibrate off the longest written dimension** on the sheet, never off a short one — small reading errors shrink as the line gets longer.
- **Scanned plans stretch.** If the double-check complains, recalibrate using a dimension running the other direction.
- **Feet-and-inches or meters** — the toggle in the toolbar switches everything, including the input boxes.
- **The amber badge is a button.** If a page says "Scale not confirmed — fix", click it any time to run the double-check and turn it green.
- **Need an unusual scale?** "Common scales... → Custom..." lets you type any ratio (1:60) or inches-per-foot ($3/16" = 1'$).

Updates come to you: the app checks for new versions by itself. A flashing "**New update**" button appears at the top — click it, then click "Restart to update". The ✓ **Latest version** pill up there means you're current.

PaintTakeoff · questions or weird plan files → send them back to Nicholas with a note about what you tried